

Quote Wizard Form Audit

The "Build My Estimate" form on the Auto Detailing & Ceramic Coating Google Ads landing page

Page audited: /auto-detailing-websites

Date: May 29, 2026

Component: QuoteFlowSection.astro

Scope: The 5-step quote form only

Submit handler: LandingLayout.astro

Pricing source: PRICING.md

The bottom line

The form is **well built and on the right strategy**. It uses the single highest-converting pattern available for a local-service site — an interactive quote calculator instead of a "contact us" box (independent studies put that at **200–400% more conversions**). The 5-step structure, the progress bar, the easy no-personal-info first question, the partial-lead capture, and the price positioning are all things you'd want to see. Pricing is **100% consistent** across the form, the page, and your master pricing file — and the internal-only care plans are correctly kept off it.

One thing must be fixed before you spend a dollar on Google Ads: the form fires **no conversion signal** when someone submits. There is no Google Ads tag, no GA4, and no GTM container anywhere on the site, and the submit "success" code doesn't even push an internal event. You would be paying for clicks completely blind — Google's bidding would have nothing to optimize toward, and you could not tell which ads produce real quotes. This is a launch blocker.

Beyond that, there is **one functional bug to verify and harden** (the Enter key can submit the form early), and **two conversion levers worth testing** (requiring a phone number, and gating the price reveal behind contact info). Everything else is polish.

Priority scoreboard

Priority	Count	What it means
P0 Launch blocker	1	Do not run paid ads until this is fixed.
P1 Fix before launch	3	A real bug or a measurable conversion leak.
P2 Worth testing / fixing soon	4	Low effort, likely upside.
P3 Polish	3	Nice to have.
OK Verified strong	10+	No action — see "What's already working."

What's already working (validated against research)

Each of these is something the form does *right* — confirmed both in the code and against current conversion research (sources at the end).

Strength in the form	Why it matters
It's a quote calculator, not a contact form	Interactive quote tools convert 200–400% better than "request a quote" boxes and produce better-qualified, self-screening leads.
Multi-step (5) with a progress bar + "Step X of 5" + "~60 seconds"	Multi-step forms convert ~86% higher than one long form; visible progress adds another 20–30% completion. 4–5 steps is the sweet spot for a high-consideration purchase like this.
Step 1 asks zero personal info (just "what does your shop do?")	Starting with an easy, commitment-free click is the classic foot-in-the-door move — people who start a multi-step form tend to finish it.
Only 2 required fields (name + phone)	3–5 fields is the optimal range; every extra field costs ~4% conversion. Business name and email are correctly optional.
Partial-lead capture before the final screen	Name/phone are saved a step <i>before</i> the price reveal, so people who bail at the estimate still land in your inbox. This recovers leads most forms lose.
Honeypot anti-spam + graceful error message	Hidden botcheck field blocks bots; if the send fails, the user is told to call/text Bill instead of hitting a dead end.
Accessibility fundamentals	Live "Step X of 5" announcement, progress bar ARIA, alert roles on errors, focus moves to each new step, and a no-JavaScript fallback that shows the phone number.
Honest expectation-setting copy	"Ballpark, not a contract," "Bill replies within 24 hours," "No spam, no list-selling" — all reduce form anxiety right next to the ask.

Findings by priority

P0 No conversion tracking fires when the form is submitted

What's happening: There is no Google Ads conversion tag, no GA4, and no GTM container anywhere on the site. The form already pushes internal `quote_step` and `quote_partial_lead` events to a `dataLayer`, but nothing is loaded to receive them — and critically, the actual *success* branch (a completed submission) pushes **no event at all** and fires no Ads conversion. The submit handler still only has a placeholder comment where the tag should go.

EVIDENCE

- LandingLayout.astro — success branch (~line 431) dispatches `audit-form:success` but no `dataLayer.push` / no `gtag` conversion.
- LandingLayout.astro (~line 387) — comment: "Add Google Ads conversion tracking inside the success branch when ready."
- QuoteFlowSection.astro (lines 606, 654) — `dataLayer.push` calls exist but are inert with no container.

WHY IT'S A LAUNCH BLOCKER

You'd pay Google for every click with zero signal on whether anyone quoted. Smart Bidding has nothing to optimize, and your real cost-per-lead is invisible. The page's own FAQ even sells "a clean conversion event to optimize against" — a promise the code doesn't yet keep.

FIX (TWO PARTS)

A — accounts (you, not code): In Google Ads → Tools → Conversions, create a "Quote Wizard Submit" action (category: Submit lead form) to get a Conversion ID + Label. Optionally create a GA4 property (or a GTM container) for the funnel/drop-off data the form is already emitting. Exclude your own IP so test submits don't pollute bidding.

B — code (drop-in once you have the IDs): load the tag async in the shared `<head>`, then fire the conversion inside the existing success branch:

```
// LandingLayout.astro – inside the `if (response.ok && result.success)` block
window.dataLayer = window.dataLayer || [];
window.dataLayer.push({ event: 'quote_submit' });           // GA4/GTM funnel close
gtag('event', 'conversion', {                               // Google Ads
  send_to: 'AW-XXXXXXXXXX/yyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyy'
});
```

Note: this is the same gap recorded in your project memory ("No site-wide conversion tracking"). It affects the whole site, not just this page.

P1 Pressing Enter on Step 4 can submit the form early

What's happening: Step 4 has four text inputs (name, shop, phone, email). The form's only submit button lives on Step 5. Step validation is wired to the "Continue" buttons, **not** to the form's submit event — so if a user finishes typing their phone or email and hits **Enter** (very common), the browser can trigger the form's implicit submission, skipping the estimate screen and sending an incomplete payload (no recommended build, maybe no timeline/budget). Worst case, they see the "Quote request sent" confirmation without ever seeing their price.

EVIDENCE

- QuoteFlowSection.astro line 360 — the single `type="submit"` button (Step 5).
- No `keydown` guard exists anywhere in the wizard script; validation lives only in the `[data-next]` click handlers (line 659).

FIX (CHEAP, ELIMINATES THE WHOLE CLASS OF BUG)

```
// QuoteFlowSection.astro — add inside the IIFE
form.addEventListener('keydown', (e) => {
  if (e.key === 'Enter' && e.target.tagName === 'INPUT' && !steps[current].hasAttribute('data-estimate-step')) {
    e.preventDefault();
    steps[current].querySelector('[data-next]')?.click(); // Enter advances, never submits early
  }
});
```

Recommend a quick live test on a phone and on desktop to confirm current browser behavior before launch either way.

P1 Phone is required; email is optional — consider "phone OR email"

What's happening: The contact step requires a phone number. Research is consistent that a **mandatory phone field is the single biggest field-level conversion killer** — it can cut completion by up to ~50% because people hesitate to hand over their number before they trust you. For a paid-traffic page where every visitor cost money, that's an expensive default.

WHY IT'S NUANCED HERE

This is a *higher-intent B2B* lead (a shop owner asking for a website quote), and Bill's follow-up is a call/text. So a phone number is genuinely useful. The fix isn't to drop it — it's to stop *forcing* it: require **at least one** of phone or email. The high-intent buyers still give their phone; the hesitant ones give an email instead of bouncing entirely.

FIX

- Remove `required` from the phone input (line 265) and label both phone and email as "(one required)".
- In `stepValid()` (line 623), add: at least one of phone/email must be non-empty and valid.
- Update the Step 4 error copy (line 277) to "Add your name and a phone or email...".
- Add `inputmode="tel"` to the phone field so mobile users get the number pad.

P1 The price is shown only after contact info is taken — test reversing it

What's happening: The flow takes name + phone on Step 4, then reveals the estimate on Step 5. The research on quote calculators is clear that a big part of *why* they out-convert contact forms is that they give the number **first** — that's what removes "is this even in my budget?" anxiety. Gating the reveal behind contact info trades some of that lift for guaranteed lead capture.

THE TRADE YOU'RE MAKING

Your current design favors **capture** (partial-lead grab) over **pure UX**. That's a defensible choice — and it's softened by the fact that full prices already appear in the pricing section above the form. But it is the highest-leverage thing to A/B test on this page.

RECOMMENDATION

Once tracking (P0) is live, test a variant that shows the ballpark on Step 4 and asks for contact on Step 5 ("Send the detailed quote to..."). Keep partial-lead capture by firing it the moment the estimate is shown. Measure completed-quote rate on both. Don't change this blind — it's exactly the kind of thing the tracking is for.

P2 Every completed lead emails Bill twice

What's happening: A `[PARTIAL]` email fires when the user leaves Step 4, then the full email fires on final submit. For people who finish, that's two emails for one lead (a partial + the complete one). This is by design for abandon-recovery, and the partial now correctly carries the recommended tier — but confirm Bill actually wants both, or thread/label them so the inbox stays clean.

EVIDENCE

QuoteFlowSection.astro lines 645–657 (`firePartial`) and the Step-5 form submit. The 30s de-dupe (line 646) only stops rapid back-and-forth, not the partial+final pair.

OPTIONS

- Keep as-is if Bill likes the early heads-up (recommended for a new page — never lose a lead).
- Or include the same quote-ID/contact in both so they're obviously the same person, and filter `[PARTIAL]` into a separate Gmail label.

P2 The whole form depends on one free third-party service

What's happening: Submissions go to Web3Forms with the access key embedded in the page source. If Web3Forms is down, rate-limits the free tier, or the key gets disabled, leads fail silently (the user is told to call, which is good, but you'd never know it happened). On a page where each visitor cost ad spend, that's a real single point of failure.

RECOMMENDATION

- Do a **live end-to-end test submission** before launch and confirm the email actually lands in Bill's inbox (and isn't in spam).
- Confirm which inbox the access key routes to in the Web3Forms dashboard.
- Consider a paid Web3Forms plan (or a backup recipient) once ads are spending, plus a periodic test so a silent outage gets caught fast.

P2 The phone field accepts anything

What's happening: The phone input is `type="tel"` with no pattern, so "asdf" passes validation. A garbage phone number on a phone-first lead is a dead lead. Low frequency, but cheap to tighten.

FIX

Add a light pattern / minimum digit check in `stepValid()` (e.g. require ≥ 10 digits after stripping non-numerics) rather than a strict format that rejects valid entries. Pair with the `inputmode="tel"` from the P1 above.

P2 Step 2 asks the buyer to make a product decision

What's happening: Step 2 ("What do you need from us — just the wizard, or a new website?") asks the shop owner to choose a product line. Some owners won't know the difference, which adds cognitive load mid-form. It's mitigated well by the "Not sure yet — show me both" option, and the routing is genuinely needed to ballpark the right budget range — so this is a minor note, not a defect. If Step 2 ever shows drop-off in the analytics, that's the first place to simplify.

P3 "About 60 seconds" is slightly optimistic

Five steps with several multi-selects plus four contact fields is realistically ~90 seconds. It's fine as a hook, and lowballing perceived effort helps people start — just know it's marketing, not a stopwatch.

P3 Add per-field momentum cues

The Step-4 header already says "Last few — then your estimate," which is good. A tiny "see your price next →" near the Step-4 submit button would reinforce the reward and reduce drop at the contact ask.

P3 Consider auto-advancing single-choice steps

Steps 2 (product line) and the timeline/budget radio groups are single-choice. Auto-advancing (or auto-focusing the Continue button) the instant a radio is picked shaves taps. Optional — don't do it on the multi-select steps (1 and 3), where people need to pick several before moving on.

Pricing audit

Every price the form can show was traced back to your master pricing file. **They all match — no drift.**

Tier	In the form's logic	On the page's pricing cards	In PRICING.md	Match
Form T1 — Quote	\$997	\$997	\$997	✓
Form T2 — Quote + Reviews	\$1,497	\$1,497	\$1,497	✓
Form T3 — Quote + Booking	\$2,497	\$2,497	\$2,497	✓
Website T1 — Starter Site	\$1,497	\$1,497	\$1,497	✓
Website T2 — Quote Site	\$2,497	\$2,497	\$2,497	✓
Website T3 — The Works	\$4,497	\$4,497	\$4,497	✓

- **Care plans correctly hidden.** The \$97/\$197/\$297 monthly care plans are internal-only and never appear in the form's estimate panel — exactly as PRICING.md requires. The estimate explicitly says "install only / no required monthly."
- **Budget ranges map to the right tiers.** The Step-4 budget buckets (\$0.5k–\$1k, \$1k–\$2k, etc.) line up with the correct tier per line, and the "budget vs. goals" mismatch note is logically sound (handles both under- and over-budget cases).
- **Routing recommendation has a sensible floor.** A "new website with the wizard" visitor is never recommended the wizard-less Starter Site — the Quote Site is the floor for that path.
- **Schema matches.** The page's structured data advertises \$997–\$4,497, consistent with the tiers.

Market positioning check. Independent 2025 pricing guides put a custom small-business website at **\$3,000–\$15,000** (freelancers \$1,000–\$5,000; a 10+ page custom site with SEO & lead-gen \$5,000–\$8,000), with **\$150–\$500/month** ongoing being normal. Your form quotes **\$997–\$4,497 one-time with no required monthly and full ownership** — and delivers *more* than a brochure site (a working quote engine). You sit at the affordable end of the market while offering the higher-value product. That's a strong, defensible position, and it confirms your own internal note that there's room to raise prices later as proof accumulates.

Step-by-step copy & "are we asking the right questions?" review

Step	Question / copy	Verdict
1 — Services	"Which of these does your shop do?" (multi-select, no PII)	Right question, right place. Easy, commitment-free opener that gets people moving. Keep.
2 — Product line	"What do you need from us?" (just the wizard / new site / not sure)	Necessary for pricing; well-written with a "not sure" escape hatch. Slight cognitive load — watch its drop-off once tracking is on (P2).

3 — Goals	"What should the site actually do?" (7 outcome options)	Good — outcome-framed, drives the recommendation. Seven options is the upper limit; fine as multi-select.
4 — Timeline + budget + contact	"Last few — then your estimate." Timeline, budget, name*, shop, phone*, email.	Strong momentum copy and trust line. Two friction points to test: phone <i>required</i> (P1) and asking contact before the price (P1).
5 — Estimate + submit	"Your shop looks like a fit for the [tier]." + "Send my detailed quote ↗"	Excellent. Personalized reward, honest "ballpark not a contract" framing, clean CTA, and a confirmation screen with a call/text fallback.

Voice check: No "solutions," no "guaranteed results," no fake metrics, no Fitchin dollar figures. Reassurance copy ("No spam, no list-selling," "Bill replies within 24 hours") is on-brand and well-placed next to each ask. Passes the voice rules.

Pre-launch checklist for the form

#	Do this before sending paid traffic	Priority
1	Create the Google Ads conversion action + (recommended) GA4/GTM container; add the tag and fire it in the submit success branch.	P0
2	Add the <code>keydown</code> guard so Enter advances instead of submitting early; test on phone + desktop.	P1
3	Switch the contact step to "phone OR email" required; add <code>inputmode="tel"</code> .	P1
4	Run a live end-to-end test submission; confirm the email lands in Bill's inbox (not spam) and routes correctly.	P2
5	Decide on the partial-vs-final double email (keep, or thread/label them).	P2
6	Add a light phone-format check to cut garbage numbers.	P2
7	After launch, queue the "show price before contact" A/B test once you have ~2 weeks of conversion data.	P1

Research & sources

Findings above were checked against current (2025–2026) conversion research and website-pricing benchmarks:

- **Multi-step forms & step count:** [Venture Harbour](#), [LeadGen Economy \(86% lift\)](#), [Zuko](#).
- **Field count & phone-vs-email friction:** [Keap](#), [REM Web Solutions](#), [Neil Patel](#), [Brixon \(B2B\)](#).
- **Quote calculators vs contact forms:** [Silver Spider Media](#), [Quotify](#).
- **Website pricing benchmarks (2025):** [Devine Solutions Group](#), [Leadpages](#), [Lounge Lizard](#).